# QR Codes

Inclusion Toolkit

## What is it for?

A QR (Quick Response) code is a type of two-dimensional barcode. It's a machine-scannable image that a smartphone camera can read to link a physical item to a website or app.

QR codes create significant barriers if not implemented carefully. These barriers include:

- Users who are blind or have low vision cannot easily locate or scan a QR code
- A standard code provides no information about its destination before being scanned

## How to support it

- Always include a short, readable URL and a clear description of the link's purpose next to the code
- Use high-contrast colours (dark on light), a large size (at least 1 inch x 1 inch), and place it at a height reachable by all users

If you can avoid using a QR code, you should. Alternatives include short URLs, NFC tags and Accessible QR (AQR) codes.

## Useful Links

Accessibility and QR codes
What is an Accessible QR (AQR) code?
Making QR codes more accessible
Are QR Codes Accessible for People with Disabilities?
Accessible QR Codes – The Ultimate Guide